

# Shelf-Thought, Inc.

## Brand Identity System · Version 2.0

SELF TAUGHT. BIGGER THINKING.

**The name is the idea.** Shelf-Thought is intentional wordplay on *Self-Taught*. The identity should celebrate independent learning while using the shelf as a subtle visual metaphor for accumulated knowledge.

### Brand promise

You do not have to wait for someone else to teach you. You can learn, investigate, build, and develop your own point of view.

### Audience

Self-directed learners, researchers, makers, professionals, entrepreneurs, investigators, and curious people who build knowledge through exploration.

# 1. Concept & positioning

The primary visual device is a row of rising book spines. It has three readings: a shelf of knowledge, the accumulation of self-taught skills, and an upward trajectory. The mark deliberately avoids a literal graduation cap or lightbulb so the brand can serve education, research, technology, consulting, publishing, or knowledge products without becoming a generic school logo.

## Core characteristics

Independent · Curious · Intelligent · Practical · Progressive · Grounded

## Primary tagline

**SELF TAUGHT. BIGGER THINKING.**

## 2. Logo system

### Primary horizontal

Default corporate mark for websites, letterhead, reports, proposals, presentations, invoices, and formal communications.

### Stacked mark

Compact alternative for square layouts, title pages, event signage, and merchandise.

### Icon mark

Use the book-spine icon alone for favicon, social avatar, app icon, watermark, sticker, and small-format merchandise.

### Clear space

Reserve at least the height of the capital S around the logo. Never allow text, borders, or other graphics to touch the mark.

### Prohibited treatments

No stretching, rotation, skewing, artificial shadows, bevels, arbitrary gradients, or unapproved colors. Avoid busy photographic backgrounds behind the full-color logo.

### 3. Color system

| Color     | HEX     | Meaning / use                       |
|-----------|---------|-------------------------------------|
| Deep Navy | #0B2D4A | Primary brand / depth / credibility |
| Teal      | #00A8A8 | Learning / discovery / links        |
| Amber     | #F5A623 | Curiosity / insight / emphasis      |
| Warm Gray | #F5F4EF | Primary light background            |
| Charcoal  | #374151 | Body text / secondary text          |
| White     | #FFFFFF | Reverse logo / dark applications    |

#### Color balance

Navy and warm gray should carry most of the visual weight. Teal is the main active accent. Amber is an intentional highlight and should not become the dominant field color.

## 4. Typography

**Montserrat** — headlines, wordmark-adjacent typography, navigation, labels, section titles. Recommended weights: SemiBold and Bold.

**Inter** — body copy, reports, captions, forms, UI, and long reading. Recommended weights: Regular and Medium.

### Typographic principle

The brand should look like something written by people who know what they are talking about, not like a motivational poster. Use whitespace, restrained hierarchy, and concise statements.

## 5. Graphic language

### Shelf pattern

Repeat simplified book spines at varied heights. Use as a footer, border, presentation accent, packaging texture, or subtle web background.

### Rising bars

The book-spine rhythm can be abstracted into a four-bar motif for charts, dividers, loading indicators, and UI decoration.

### Knowledge annotations

Use small labels such as “Shelf Note,” “Deep Dive,” “Field Note,” or “Thought Index” only when they describe real content structures.

## 6. Stationery

### Letterhead

Logo upper-left, contact block upper-right, restrained divider, generous writing area, and a small shelf/brand accent in the footer.

### Business card

Use a navy reverse side for strong contrast. Keep personal information simple; let the mark and tagline carry the identity.

### Envelope

Primary logo in the upper-left; a small rising-spine accent can appear near the flap or lower-right.

### Email signature

Icon plus name/title/contact information. Keep the tagline optional in highly formal correspondence.

## 7. Digital identity

### Website

Warm gray or white canvas, navy typography, teal interactions, amber emphasis. Use the icon as a compact navigation or footer device.

### Social

The icon is the default avatar. Quote cards and educational posts can use large Montserrat headlines framed by a shelf pattern.

### Presentation & reports

Use strong title pages, clear section labels, restrained book-spine graphics, and plenty of whitespace. The visual system should support serious information rather than decorate it.

## 8. Voice & messaging

### Voice

Intelligent, direct, curious, independent, and useful. Avoid inflated claims and educational clichés. Speak to the reader as a capable person.

### Message territory

Self-directed learning · curiosity · research · experimentation · practical knowledge · original thinking · intellectual independence

### Approved-style examples

“Learn your way.” · “Think for yourself.” · “Knowledge you earn.” · “Built by curiosity.” · “What you learn becomes what you think.”

## 9. Brand applications

Recommended core collateral

Logo suite · business cards · letterhead · envelopes · email signature · invoice · proposal template · report template · presentation deck · social avatar · social post templates · website favicon · document cover · notebook · apparel · tote · mug · signage.

### Future extensions

The Shelf-Thought name supports a coherent naming family if the company develops products: Shelf Notes, Deep Shelf, Thought Index, Idea Shelf, Reference Shelf, and Thought Stack are examples.

### Production note

This kit is a strong digital/creative starting system. Before trademark filing or mass production, commission a final vector/typographic refinement and verify trademark availability in the jurisdictions where the company will operate.

## 10. Included files

Primary, reversed, monochrome, stacked, and icon SVG logos; shelf pattern; accent-bar element; letterhead template; business-card template; HTML email-signature starter; brand README; and this brand-guidelines PDF.

**Identity principle: The shelf is what you accumulate. The thought is what you make of it.**